EXCALIBUR: 3/5

JOSHUA WILLIAMSON TOM REILLY JORDIE BELLAIRE

DEATH OF THE DARK KNIGHT

Image

#15

aftermath

CODENAME:

后天灾害

[MISSION LOG [03.015.01]

LEAD OPERATIVES:

JOSHUA WILLIAMSON
[WRITER]

TOM REILLY
[ARTIST]

JORDIE BELLAIRE
[COLORIST]

RUS WOOTON
[LETTERER]

COVER SUPPORT:

TOM REILLY

ERIC CANETE

BEN OLIVER

JESUS MERINO & ADRIANO LUCAS

JONBOY MEYERS

CARLA COHEN

GROUND SUPPORT:

BEN ABERNATHY
[EDITOR]

ANDRES JUAREZ
[PUBLICATION DESIGN]

RICHARD MERCADO
[PRODUCTION]

汉化制作团队：

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鹤霜白
[翻译]

狂飙
[校对]

幻灵虞宇
[修项]

KillMaster.C
[协力]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

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[illegible]

EV CLEMENTS
[illegible]

ANNA GEORGE
[illegible]

GREG FERGMAN
[illegible]

DAN PETERSEN
[illegible]

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[illegible]

ERIK LARSEN
[illegible]

TODD MCFARLANE
[illegible]

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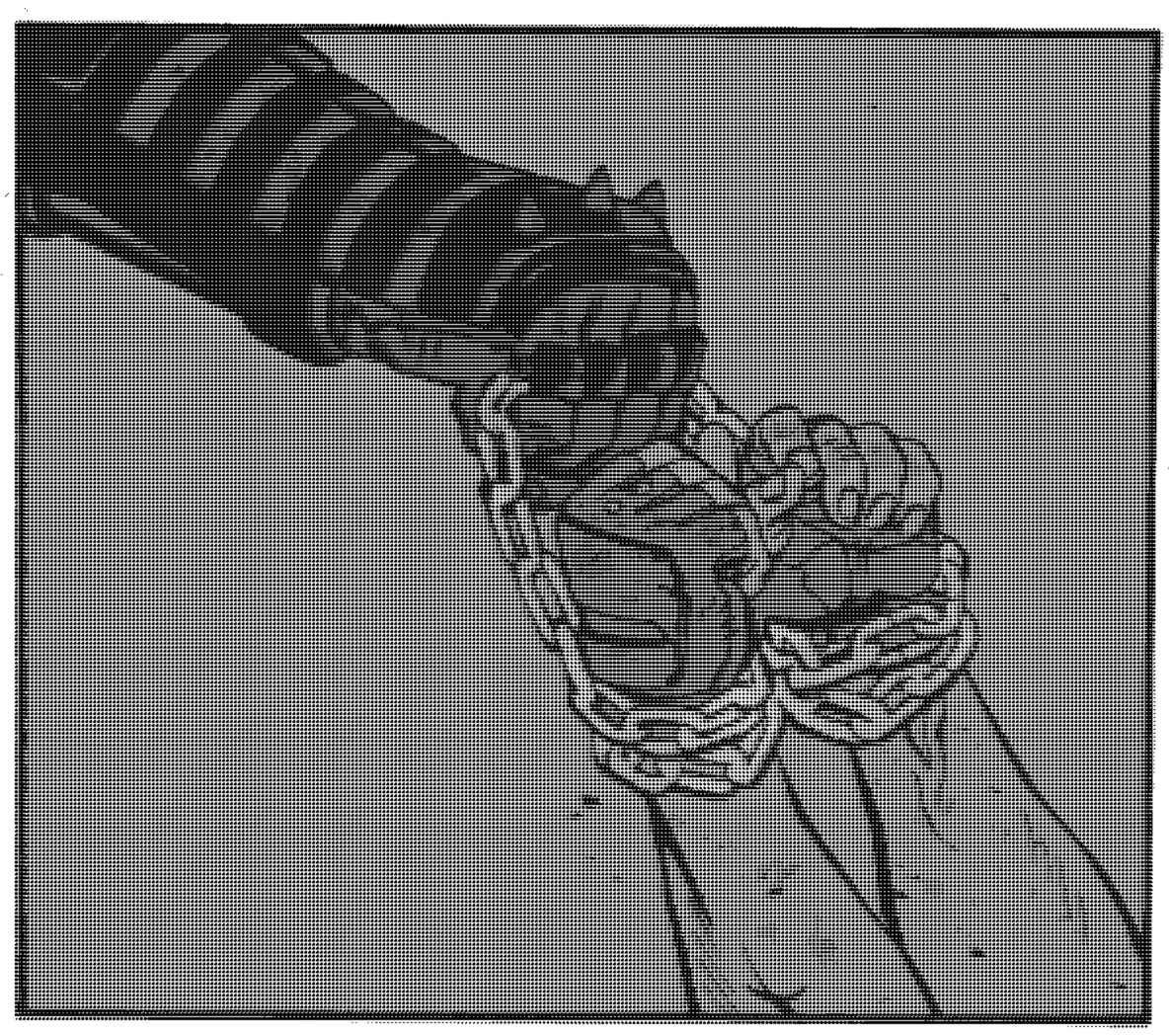
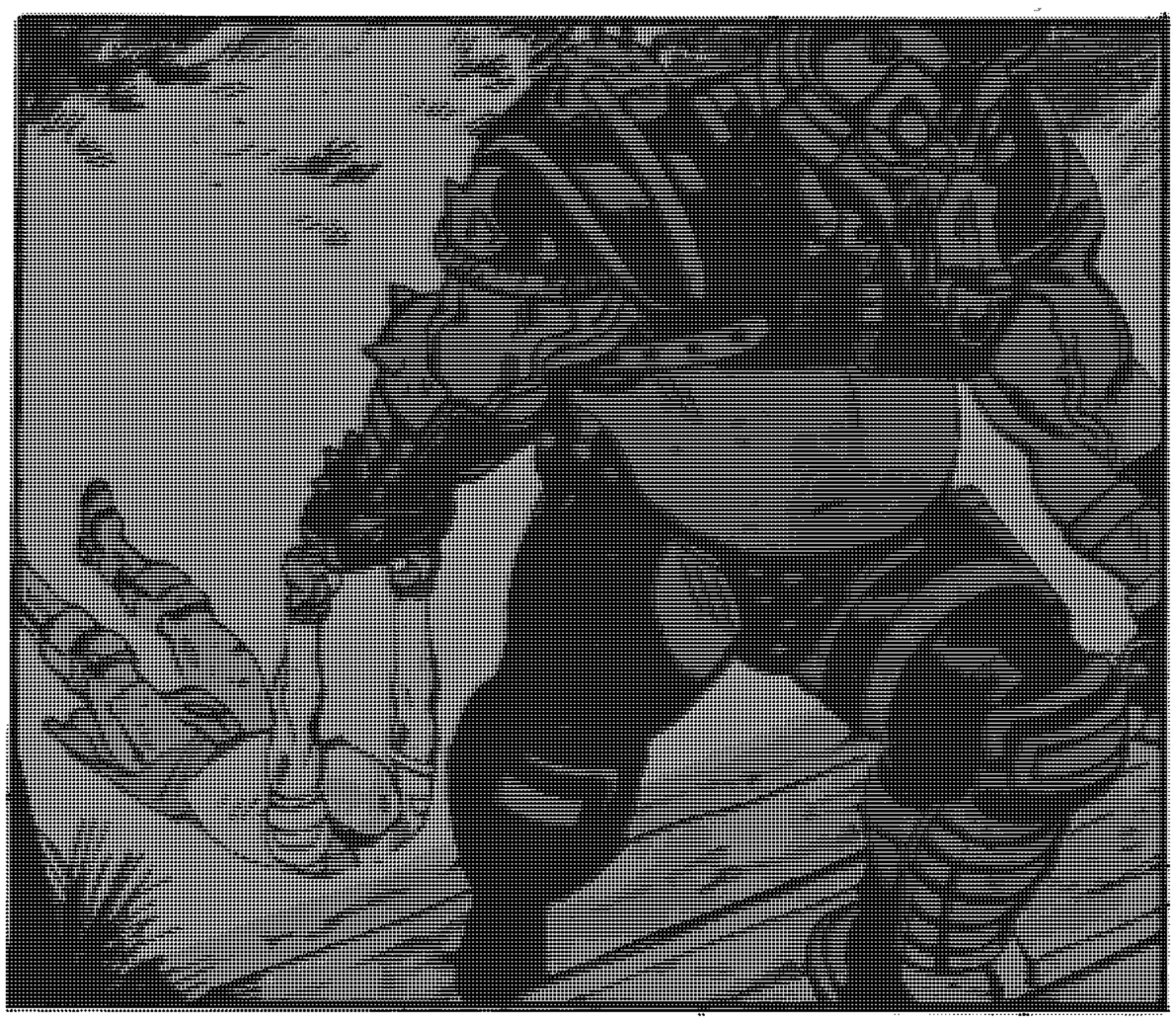
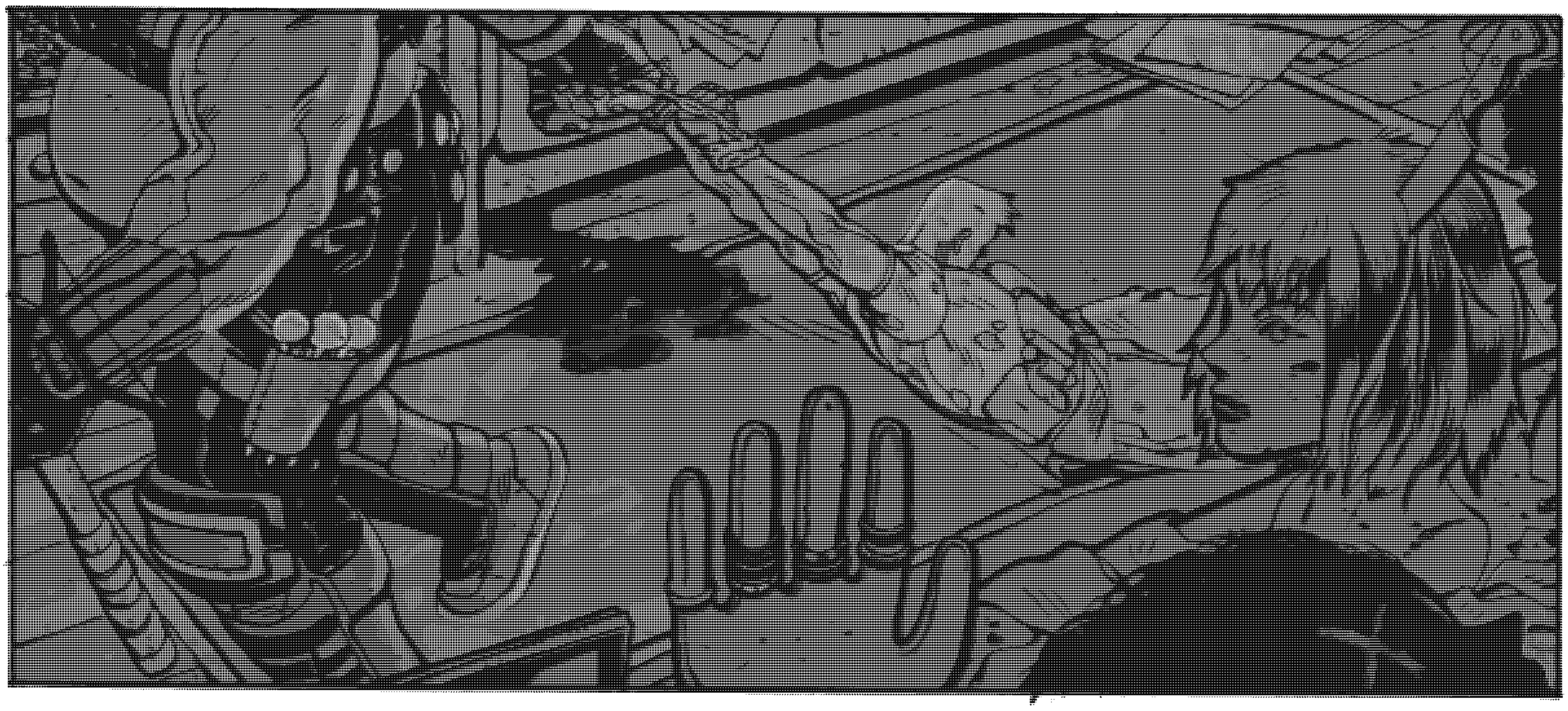
我不知道你到底是谁，伙计。
但是只要你放下你的镜子…
哪吒哪吒！

你得
就这样了。
哦……



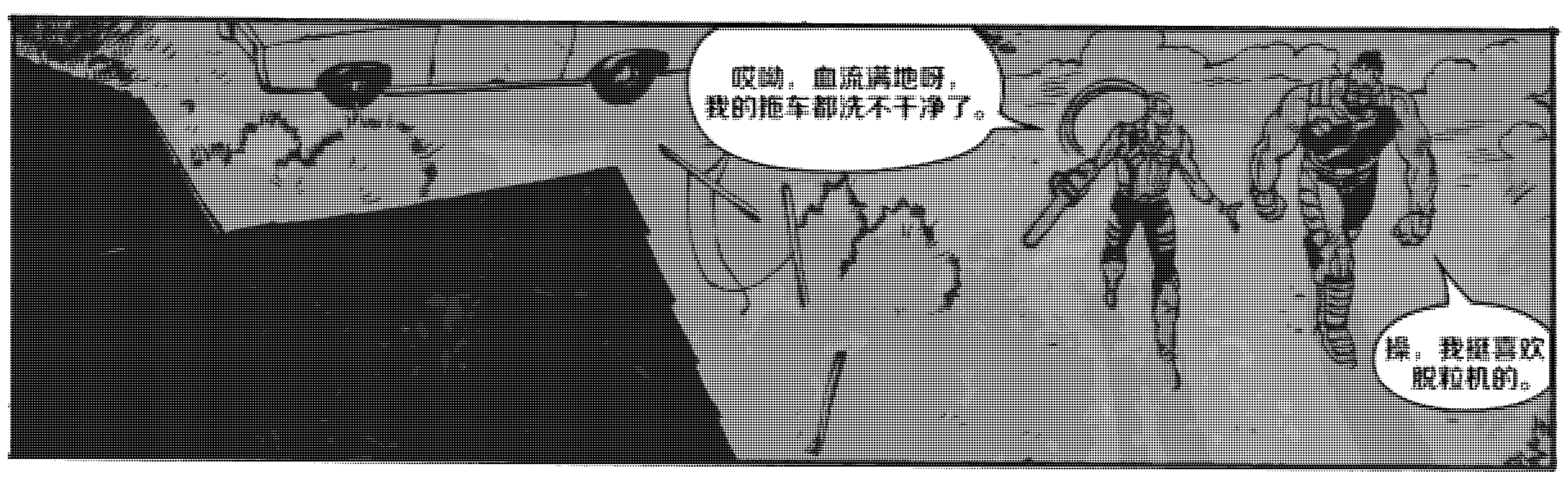




但是至少你有朋友陪你玩看…

你们都不该来我们家。
没人喜欢不速之客…

哈哈?
你们俩就在这里待着吧。
我们还有客人。



[1]脱粒机（Thresher），敢死队成员之一，1986年发售的雷霆战车的同人图（充当驾驶员）。

离我的狗远点！

YRRRR...
SKRETCCHHH

CCRHHEEEE

CCHHHEEEE

KRING!

这都什么
神神鬼鬼的？！

你到底是谁？

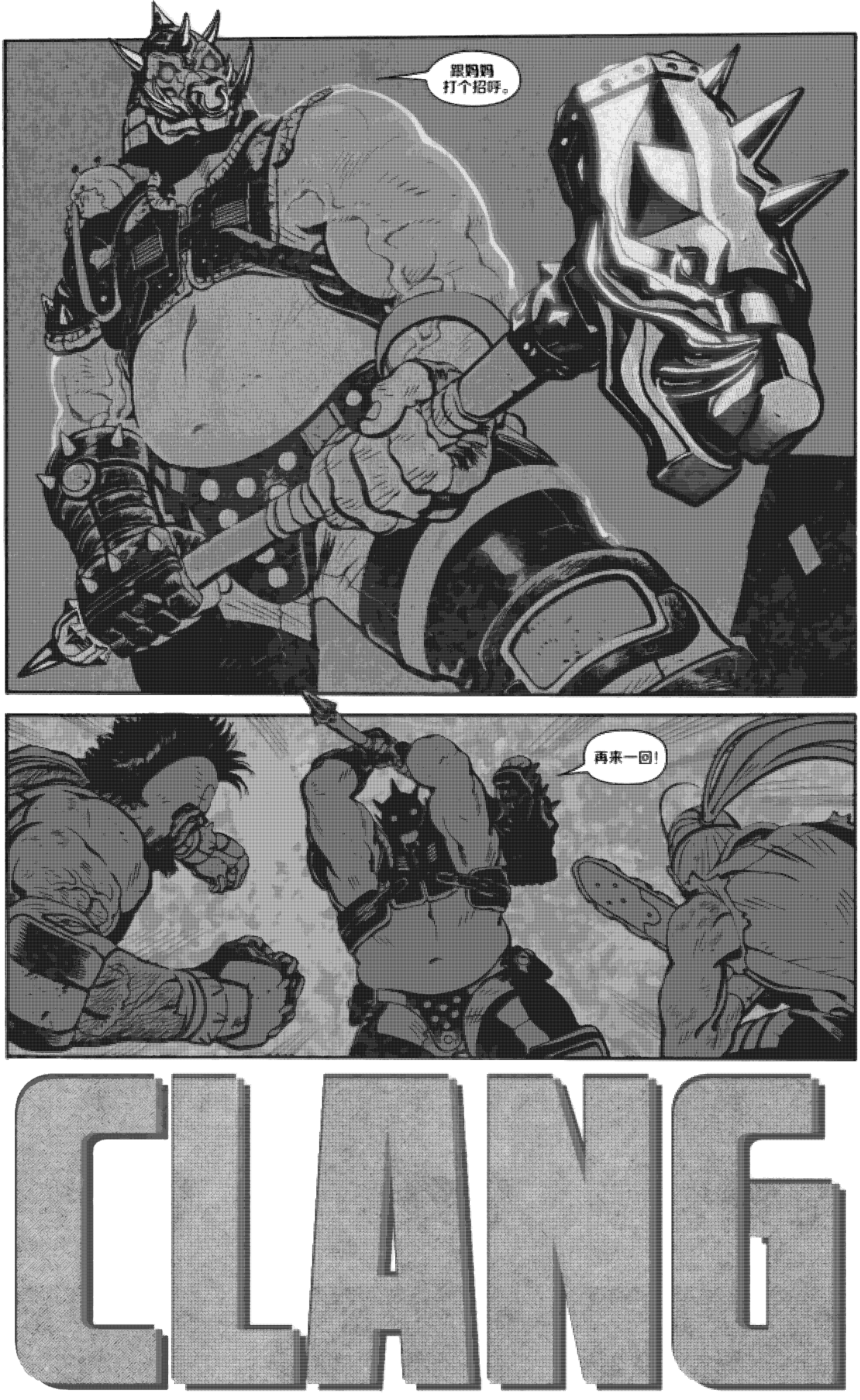
我是路路。

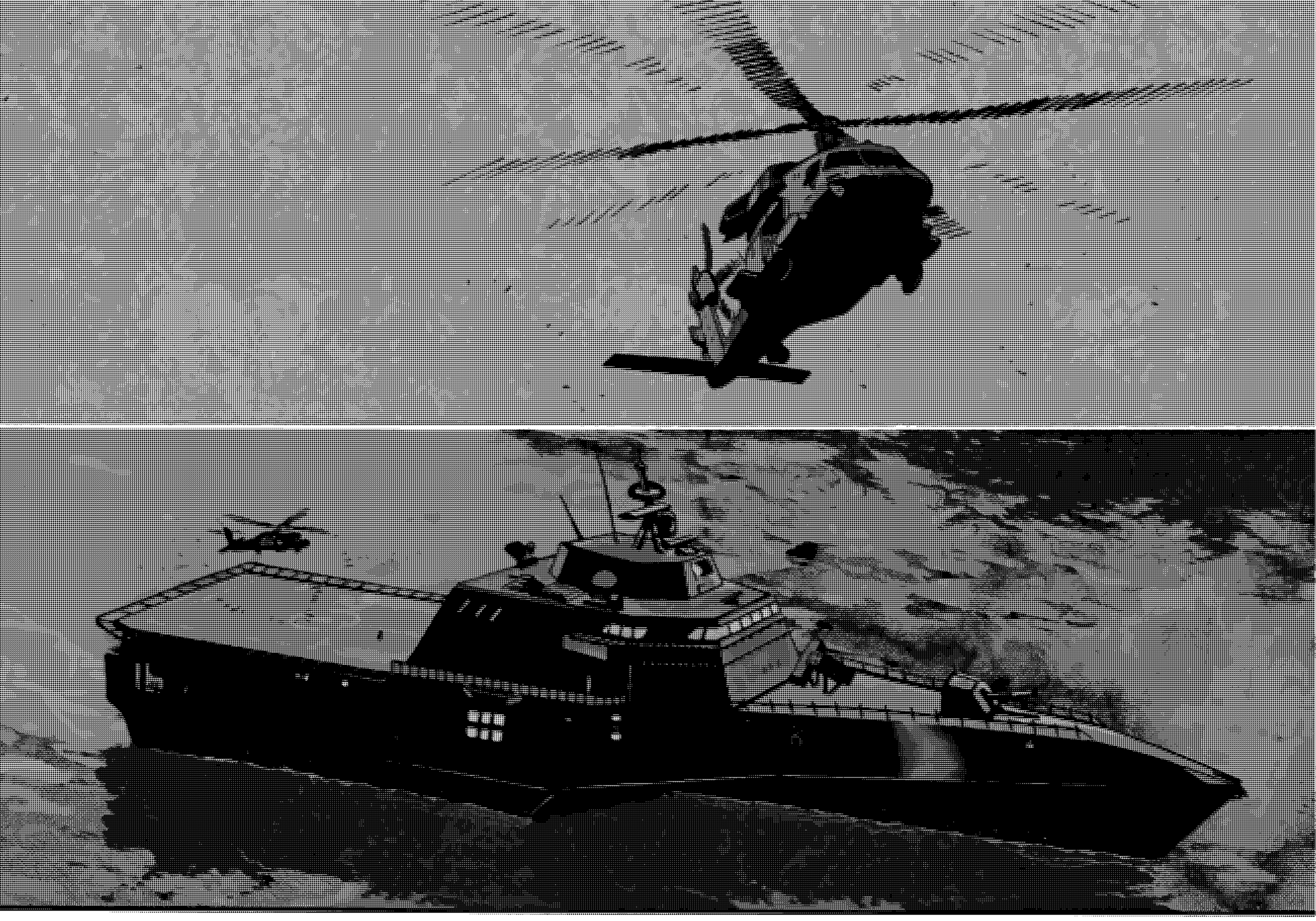
我操，你差点
弄坏了我的
玩具。

我想我得拿出
我更好的收藏。

KICK!

我本想留着它用在
特殊场合呢。


啊啊
打个招呼。
再来一回！
CLANG!



[1]阿斯托莉亚·卡尔顿-丽思（Astoria Carlton-Ritz），最早登场于G1《变形金刚》动画，爱上情报机的贵族富家女。关于她的故事，详见“能量块宇宙”《迪斯特罗》漫画。

迪斯特罗
领主。

不仅仅是停战，
我相信我们更能
达成合作，
霍克上校。

眼镜蛇的武器
在你和机器人
的战斗中可能
大有用处。

阿斯托莉亚，
你疯了？

迪斯特罗
是敌人！

阿斯托莉亚，
你告诉过我这是一次
友好的交换意见。

会是的，
亲爱的。

霍克，世界上有
很多事你不知情。

眼镜蛇正在经历
一次…管理层上的
变动。

为了抛出
做模样…

迪斯特罗的安全主管，
姆布商，有你可能不知道
的情报，关于你的队伍
和那些机器人…

我…
不是…
你为什么救我?
因为那个大畜生随时都会回来，可能会把我们一锅端了。
为什么?

你有我需要的情报。我相信你知道那些机器人是什么。

我认为你是这个世界上很多疯狂事儿的关键，我很想和你谈谈……问一些问题。

嗯。你可能不喜欢这些问题的答案。

那么，我们试试。

你是人类吗？

我不是。

行，你就糊弄吧。

我不喜欢我们的肉体。我们的生命极限。这个世界是多么脆弱啊。

我想成为超越人类的存在。演变、飞升。

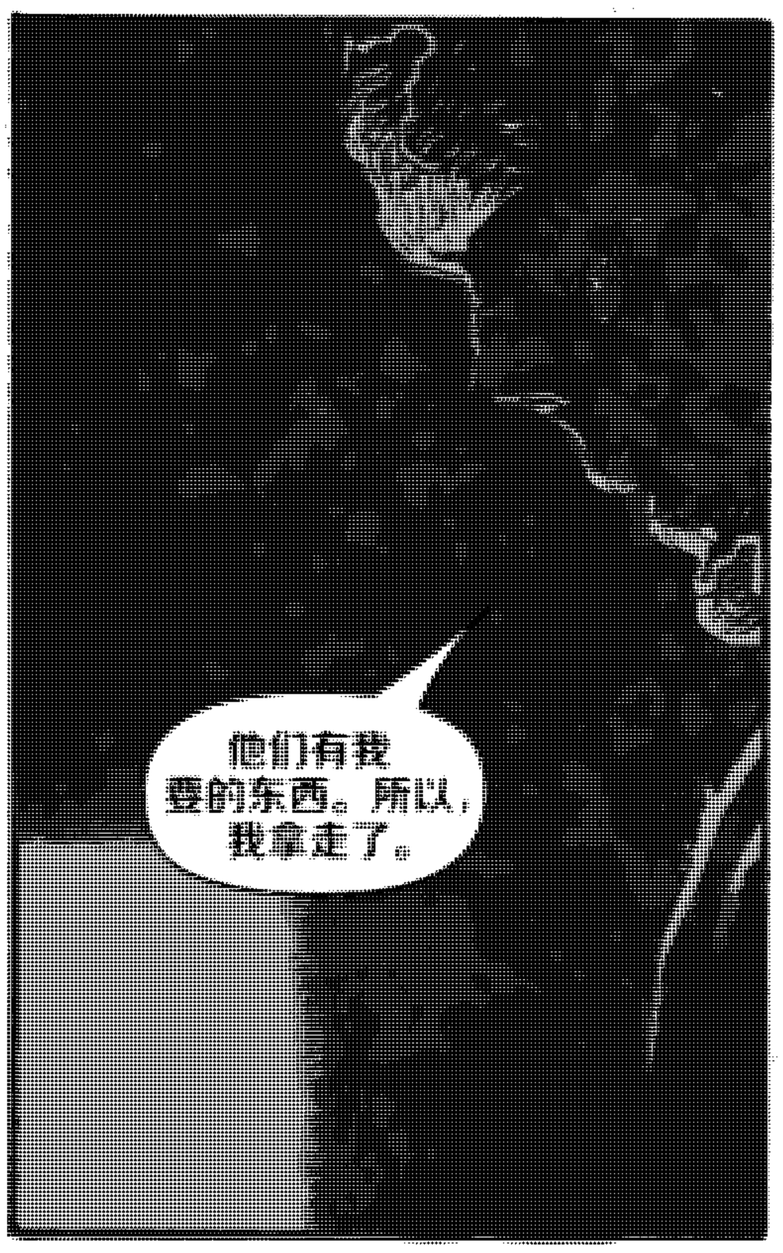
所以，那些机器人不是你造的？

不是。但是想象一下，如果你有他们的能力。你能做什么？

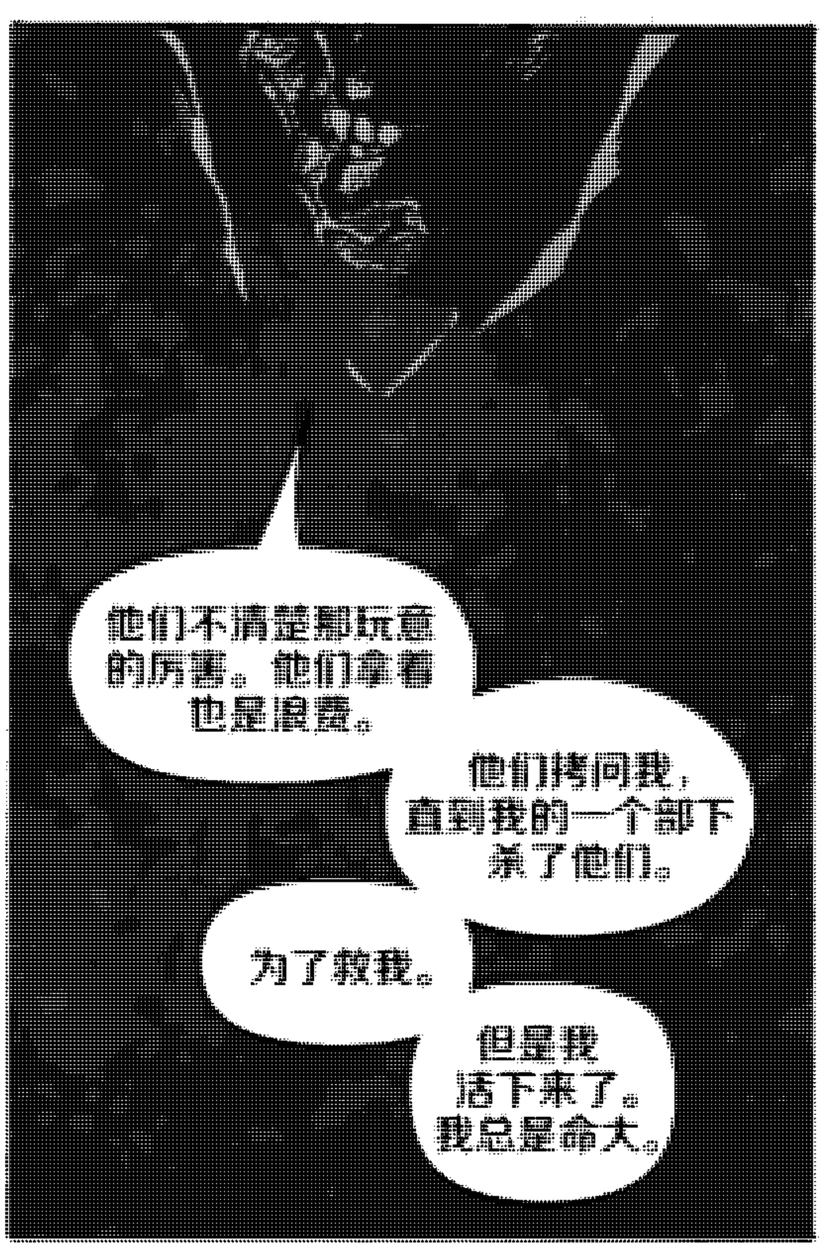
我不想成为一个
该死的机器人。

那你就是个
傻子。

有人说我说得
更狠呢。
下个问题。
为什么
这些乡巴佬
要杀你?


他们有我
要的东西。所以,
我拿走了。

你从他们那里
偷了能量块,
是不是?


他们不清楚那玩意
的厉害。他们拿着
也是浪费。
他们拷问我,
直到我的一个部下
杀了他们。
为了救我。
但是我
活下来了。
我总是命大。

你知道…要是人们
总是想杀你,也许你
需要思考你的
生活方式了。

一个在我身边
等着被处决的人
好意思说这话。

哈哈哈
哈哈哈
哈哈哈
哈哈哈

嗯，好家伙，
你没跟说。
好像两扇猪肉。

我们的塔猪兄弟真能干，
不过一旦我们逃开了，
我们知道他和我们一样
喜欢葡萄汽水。

他有一只乘狗狗。
还有一身特装备。
我们受封他为
荣誉敢死队员。

拉库斯
喜欢你…

那在我这里，你就是好人。

我很高兴你们交了朋友。

你们现在要干啥？

我们好合儿。

开饭手，后面有自动贩卖机，里面都是好东西。

过奖，你这人真好意思。

指挥官…你那个长翅膀的大个子。

他伤害了我。

他伤害了敢死队。

不过我们加倍地干了。

所以，你要接受你和他的惩罚。

我找至了宝。

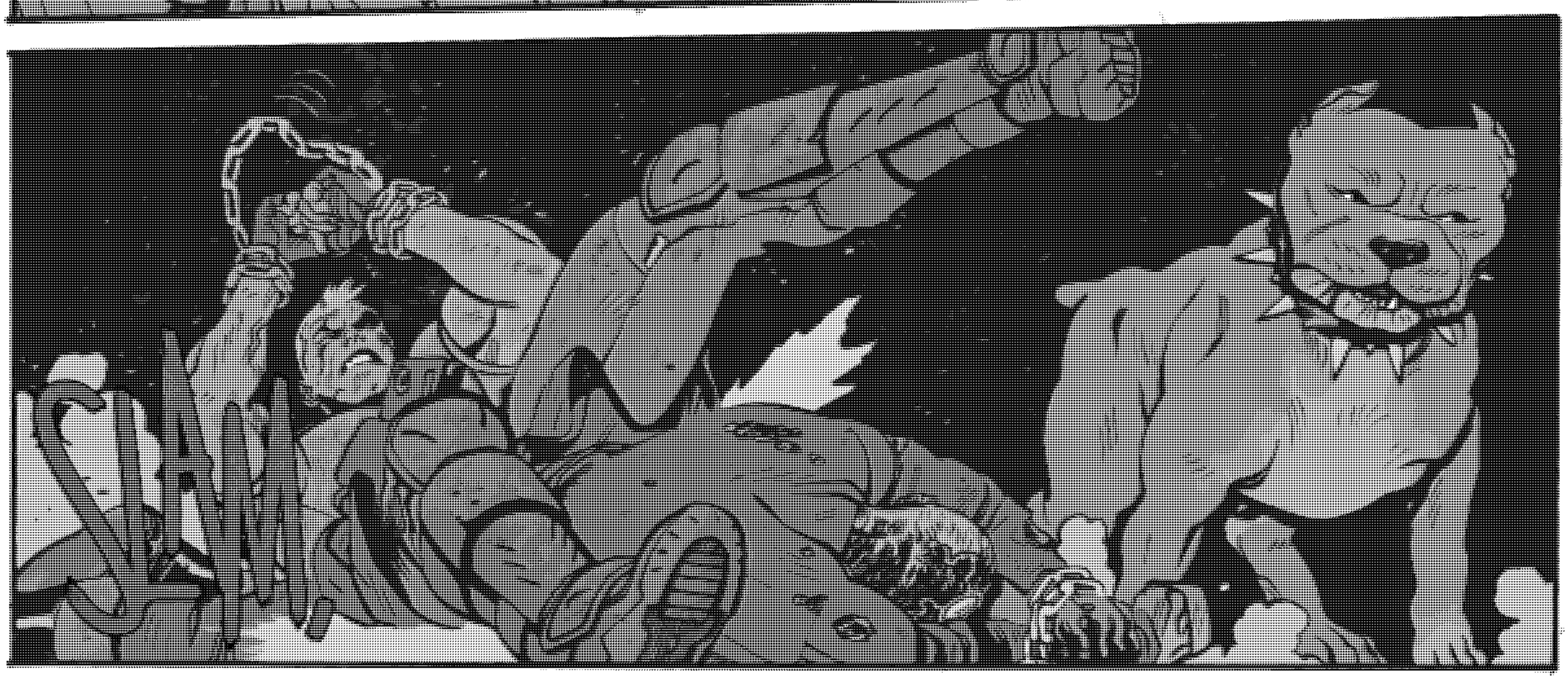
你叫丑怪了…

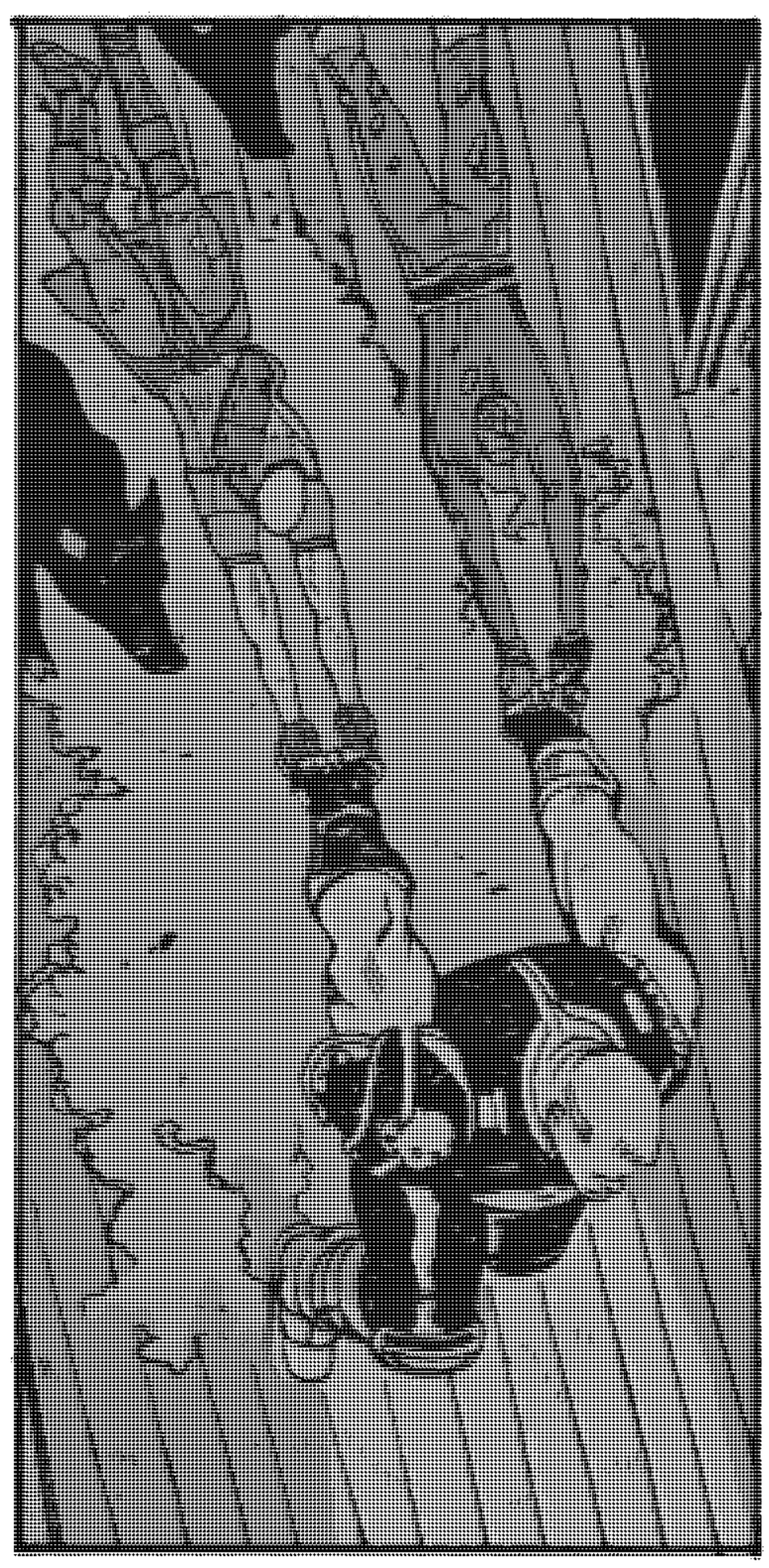
BLEE!

啊!

兄弟，他下嘴够狠的。
我——我——我——
我感觉不太妙，伙计们。

把他们扔到外面去!





你没事吧?
我没事…让我们把这条空交给我们的人,剥了他的皮。

嗯,他们和你们是一伙的?

嘿嘿嘿。

抱歉，我们花了点儿时间才换过那条山谷。假装成别的比不错好。

哦，嘿嘿。

谢谢它帮我们摆脱他们了。

大坑。

我们得做点什么。

也应该去看那个能量信号是什么，然后发回报告…

我知道霍克上校说了要按兵不动，但是公爵不会这样百后全无。不可能。

男爵夫人，里斯克和跟踪者正在芝加哥执行回收任务。

如果我们让他们放下手头的任务去找公爵，我想他们最多也要到早上才能到位…

打电话给他们。让他们知情。

但是你和我现在出发。

我知道有人能帮我们…

STRAIGHT SHOOTERS

DIRECT ALL CORRESPONDENCE TO: GIJOE@SKYBOUND.COM

WOW! What an ending_I'm not entirely sure HOW Duke and Cobra Commander are going to survive this one! (I'm kidding. I've already read all the scripts so I know what happens next lol). Also, a HUGE shoutout to the work of Tom Reilly, Jordie Bellaire, and Rus Wooton on the issue! They're absolutely bringing their A-game to this story arc and it's amazing to see!

Welcome to another STRAIGHT SHOOTERS where we're here to answer letters, talk about our favorite characters and have some fun! Joining me once again is the Commander in Chief, Joshua Williamson!

HELLO! After the last two issues we knew we needed to let everyone take a breath. It gave us an opportunity for some character moments across the board and yet still bring in some action, danger and intrigue. That all being said_the next two issues are NUTS. It gets really wild.

And yeah, Tom and Jordie are the stars of the show!

Now, let's dig into the mailbag!

Hello Joes!

I have some things I want to say and some questions I'd like to ask.

Cobra Commander is written as he should be! He is amazing! In the 80s show, he felt like what would happen if Starscream was the leader of the Decepticons. Dangerous but not as competent as he should be. Everyone wanted to replace him and would honestly probably do a better job. But here he is intimidating, competent, and capable. Everyone still wants to replace him, but it feels more like they are power hungry rather than him not being a good leader. He feels like the most powerful person on the page whenever he is there. Normally, when he and Duke face one another, I feel like they are equals, but during their first encounter, I felt as if Duke was significantly outmatched. This version of the character feels like y'all took everything about him from the original cartoon and improved it!

Thank you! Cobra Commander is one of my favorite characters. Here I wanted him to be dangerous. A bigger threat. And honestly that only took one change_this is one who never retreats. He doesn't back down. I'm glad you're enjoying our take on him.

Now, some questions. What was the decision-making behind Hound? Was it his personality or his alt mode that made y'all want to use him? Were there any other bots you were debating on?

It was always Hound. We never considered anyone else. It was his alt-mode and his explorer/scouting personality. (Also, I had his toy as a kid.)

Also, this might be the single most important question I have been wanting answered about the Energon Universe...

When Cobra Commander was experimenting on Megatron, did Megs think that this creature sounded an awful lot like a certain treacherous second in command? ;) And if so, will that ever be referenced?

-Diesel McCoy

I've thought about this a lot and the best answer I can give is_stay tuned!

Long time Joe fan, remember getting my first figures Snake Eyes and Cobra soldier when I was just 10 yrs old. The original Marvel Comics G.I. Joe: A Real American Hero comics were the first comic book I had a monthly subscription to, back when they were mail ordered. The Classified Line of figures renewed my interest in G.I. Joe a few years back and then when the Energon-verse was announced I felt like that 10 year old kid again! I was so hyped and excited for the launch of G.I. Joe and you guys have not disappointed my expectations at all, in fact you're exceeding and surpassing them with each new issue!

You are totally describing my own love of G.I. Joe. I did a lot of mail order comics as a kid. And I did the mail order G.I. Joe toys. I was already in the G.I. Joe headspace for new comics with Skybound when the Classified line started, but it easily helped turn that dial up beyond 11 for me.

Duke has always been one of my favorite characters and he's just been phenomenal in his own mini series and the ongoing G.I. Joe series. I love the dynamic between Baroness and Cover Girl, with them getting the best of Major Bludd. Hawk's secret Joe Team is excellent as well and sparks are gonna fly when Duke finds out about them for sure. Speaking of Duke finding out secrets, can't wait for Clutch to introduce him to his new buddy Hound!

I'm all geared up for The Dreadnok War. I'm sure it will be nothing short of amazing. My one question to end this on and I'm positive it had to be at the top of the list of most asked, but When Are We Gonna See Snake Eyes?!

Yo Joe!

Troy Sasher

Thank you for the letter and full support, Troy! (Ironically, I, too, got Snake Eyes and a Cobra soldier at 10 years old!) The Duke/

Hound meeting is coming and you won't be disappointed…assuming Duke SURVIVES Dreadnok War!

I know people want Snake Eyes. I do. I know we joke about it. But the most I can say is trust us. We all love the character, too. And it's because we love him so much that we know he needs the best introduction possible. So, like always…keep reading!

Team G.I. Joe,

I love what y'all are doing with this series. To start, Skybound's Energon Universe is my first introduction to the Transformers and G.I. Joe comics. I have been following these plus Void Rivals from the get-go and they have all consistently been a favorite of mine. Now enough about me and onto my questions for you all!

As we've seen, Night Force has been recruiting more team members. And Ben mentioned in the Energon Experience at the end of issue #12 that they will be searching for some more muscle. maybe a new Autobot will enter the scene? With General Flagg introducing Bulkhead and Mirage in Transformers #25, we see some type of collaboration/projects between the Military and the Autobots, but will General Hawk and Night Force do the same? Also, with Artyom Darklon and the Dreadnoks making their appearances in this series, I decided to reread each of the mini-series leading up to G.I. Joe #1. It's so awesome to see some returning characters coming back, let alone headline the next story arc! Though I am left wondering when Scarlett, the Arashikage clan and the Inochi No-Ken, "Sword of Life," will make their returns too. In the meantime, thanks for masterfully creating these incredible stories!

Yo Joe,

Max

Thanks for reading and writing in, Max! Good question about an Autobot and Night Force but the muscle I was referring to was none other than Roadblock! And you'll have to keep reading to see what General Flagg and the Autobots are up to…mwahaha!

Your questions do get close to actual plans we have so…yeah…keep reading! Lots of fun stuff coming. We do try to make sure that nothing feels forgotten and we're cycling in these characters and the subplots that come with them. It's all to continue to build out the Energon Universe. The story we're leading to with Night Force will surprise you!

Yo,

I really enjoyed the self-contained nature of issue # 12. As someone who isn't very familiar with G.I. Joe, getting a quick intro into her deal, and in such a cool way, was a good read. It reminded me of the Beachcomber issue, probably my favorite in the run so far. That scene where Ivana tortures Shooter, with that first panel KRAK was so well done.

Glad you liked the Shooter issue. I love the standalone issues. It really lets the series breathe as we bring in the new characters.

One thing I hope to see going forward is a little more clarity on the goals of the various factions. Other than ego and vanity, why do Destro and Cobra Commander butt heads? If one of them got what they wanted, how would the world be different than if the other did? Same thing with the Joes. I know they are more than just generic superheroes, fighting to protect the way things are and stop the bad guys. They have so many different personalities and backstories that even keeping them united seems daunting. But why do they fight?

I'm excited for the return of Tom Reilly and the Dreadnok War next issue!

Stephen

Good to hear from you, Stephen, thank you for taking the time to write in. I would recommend checking out the back catalog of G.I. Joe-related material if you haven't already--the four character mini-series we did and the first 11 issues are pretty epic and entertaining!

Your questions will play an important role in the arc after Dreadnok War. You'll see! I hope you enjoy the work that Tom and Jordie have been doing on Dreadnok War!

And that's a wrap for another issue…see y'all in two weeks where the phrase "out of the frying pan and into the fire" becomes reality!

-Ben

Tom told us that the next issue is one of the most difficult comics he's ever drawn. So much happens in it! It gets really crazy and it's only the penultimate issue of the Dreadnok War! See you in two weeks! Yo Joe!

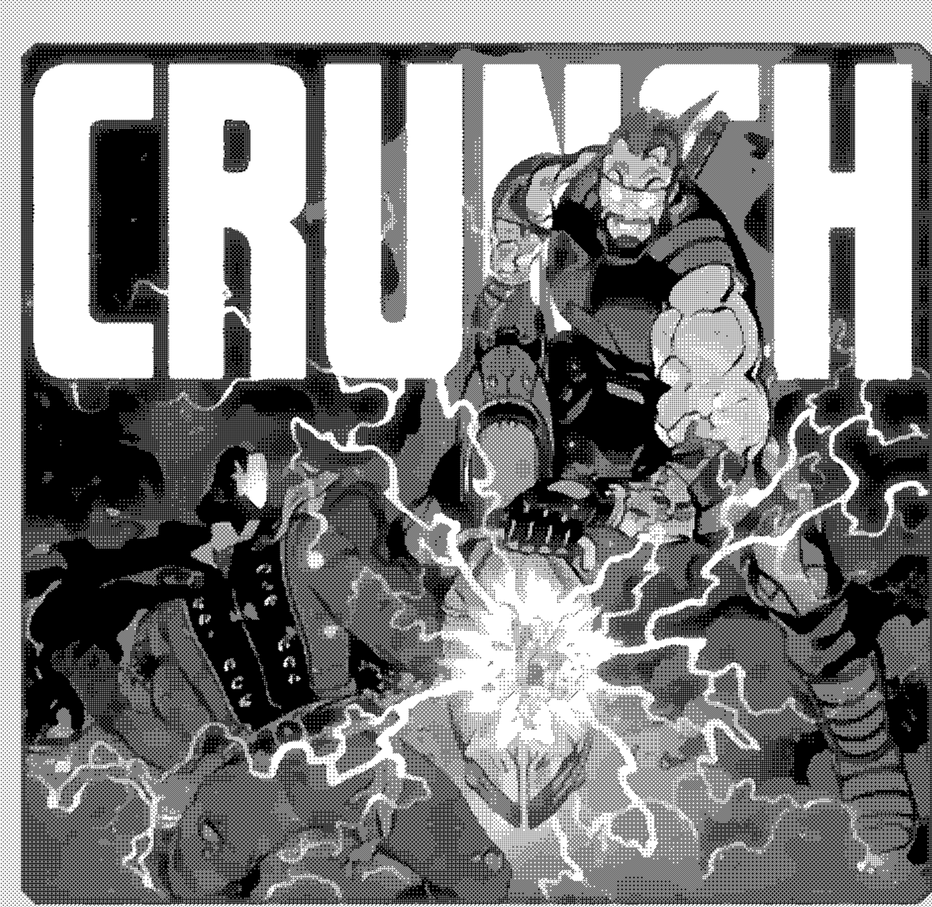
-Josh

The world lost an entertainment giant recently with Ron Friedman's passing. His work touched millions of people over the years and his work on G.I. JOE: A REAL AMERICAN HERO and TRANSFORMERS were an inspiration to us all. 'Til All Are One, may he rest in peace.

EXPERIMENTS IN PROGRESS

Our high octane, double-shipping Dreadnok War is absolutely bruising to read, and Joshua, Tom, Jordie and Rus are firing on all cylinders! But with all the blood and dirt flying in the desert with Duke and Cobra Commander trying to survive, don't lose sight of what's happening with Cobra and Colonel Hawk...

-Ben Abernathy, Executive Editor



CHARACTER SPOTLIGHT

WHO: Road Pig

WHERE: Road Pig will do anything to protect his home from intruders as Duke and Cobra Commander learned the hard way!

WHAT: A mountain of a man with a houseful of pigs and living in a remote part of the desert, Road Pig is a mysterious new ally to the Dreadnoks...

HAVE ANOTHER DRINK!

One of the most enduring elements of the Dreadnoks is their love of grape soda. For over 40 years this motley crew has bonded and partied with this deliciously specific flavor. Cheers to a friendship that runs deeper than blood!

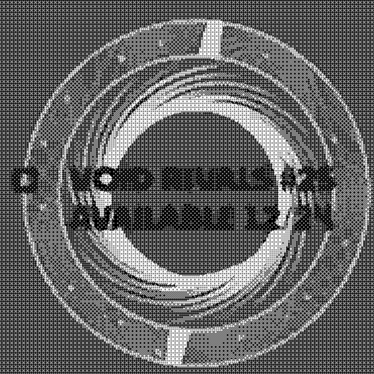
CREATOR SPOTLIGHT

This month, I ask our amazing G.I. JOE artist, Tom Reilly, the most important question of all!

Q: Tom, now that you've drawn dozens and dozens of pages of Dreadnok War...who is your favorite Dreadnok?

A: It's gotta be Ripper for me! He's always fun to draw, I really enjoyed coming up with his design for the book. And I feel like he's a very versatile character, you can play it straight with him or play him for laughs, and it feels like it works either way.

THE ENERGON UNIVERSE CHECKLIST



- ☐ VOID RIVALS #26 AVAILABLE 12/24
- ☐ G.I. JOE #15 AVAILABLE 12/3
- ☐ G.I. JOE #16 AVAILABLE 12/17
- ☐ TRANSFORMERS #27 AVAILABLE 12/10

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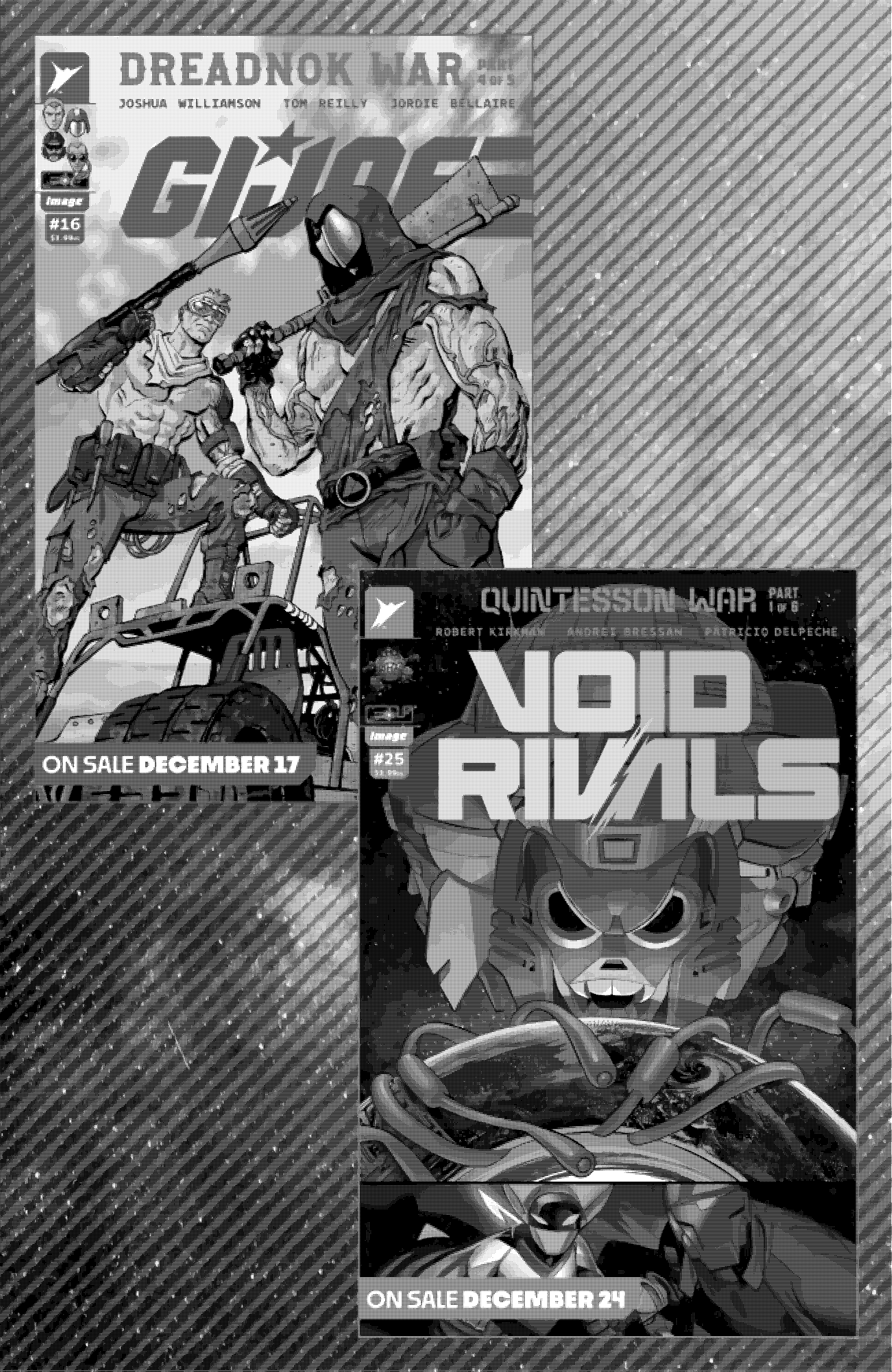
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JOSHUA WILLIAMSON TOM REILLY JORDIE BELLAIRE
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ZERTONIA.

GULAN, I HEAR YOUR CONCERNS. OUR CITY IS IN SHAMBLES. OUR DEFENSES ARE DOWN.
YES, MULAK. THE PEOPLE ARE TERRIFIED. SOME ARE TOO SCARED TO LEAVE THEIR DWELLINGS.
CULAN, I UNDERSTAND THIS IS A HUGE STEP BACK AFTER THE DISCOVERY OF ENERGON.
KANELA, YOU ASK ME IF I HAVE A PLAN FOR MOVING FORWARD IN THE WAKE OF THIS DISASTER.

I AM...
CONSIDERING MANY OPTIONS. ZERTA HAS BETRAYED US. OUR BELIEFS HAVE BEEN SHAKEN TO THEIR VERY CORE. WE MAY BE ENTERING A LONG PERIOD OF UPHEAVAL...
WE MUST PREPARE FOR--

SHRAKK!

DEATH TO ZAULAK!!
DEATH TO THE BETRAYER!!
THUNK!

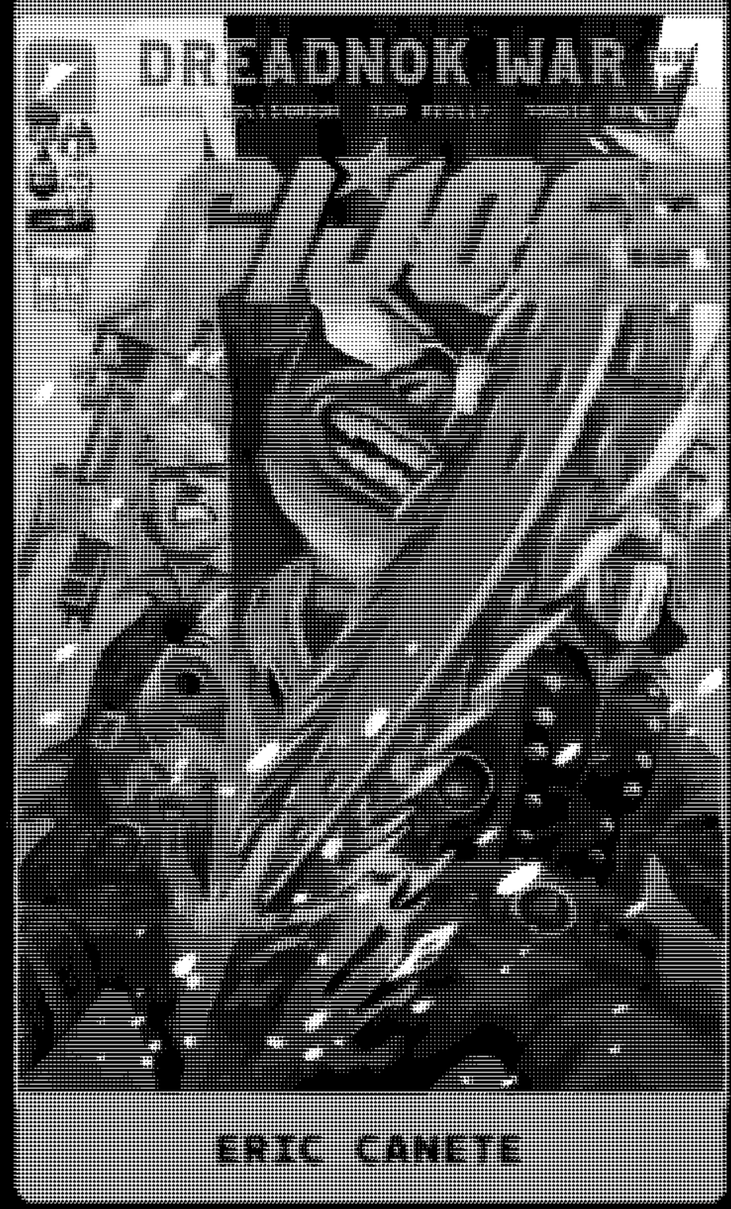
To be Continued in **VOID RIVALS #25**

COLLECT ALL THESE EXCITING ENERGON UNIVERSE COVERS

COVER A

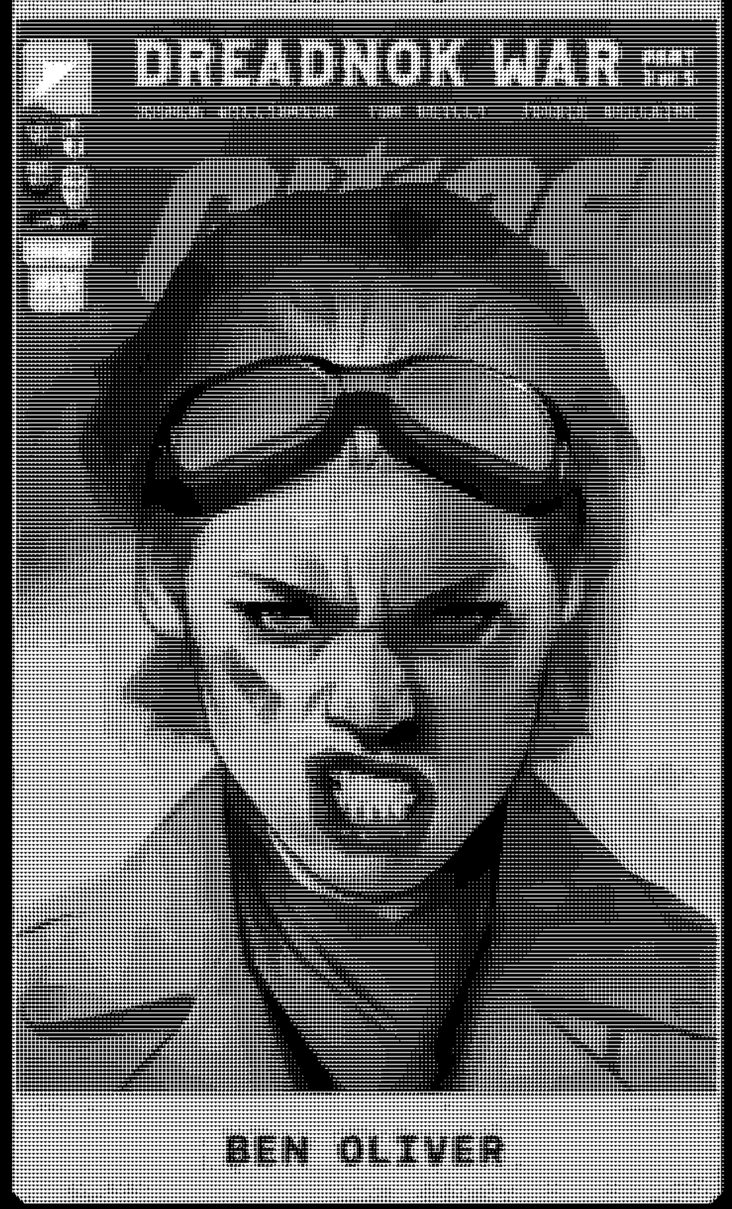
TOM REILLY

COVER B



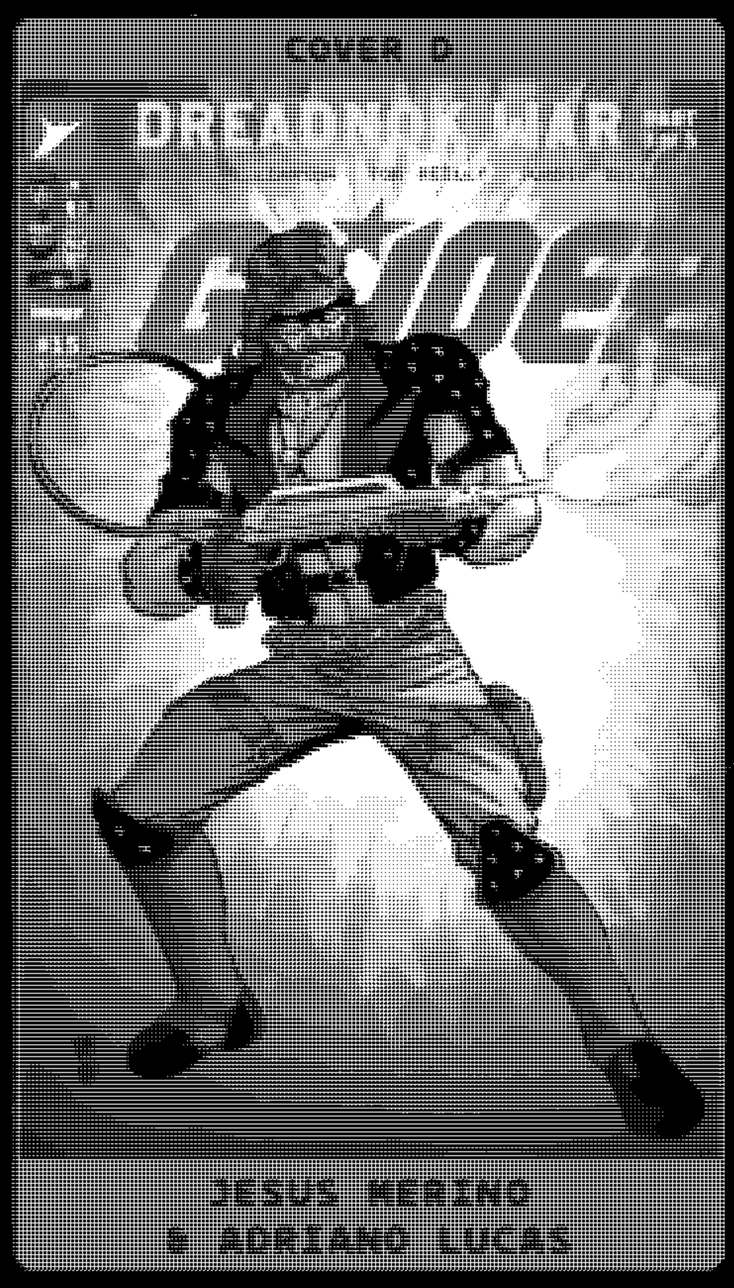
ERIC CANETE

COVER C



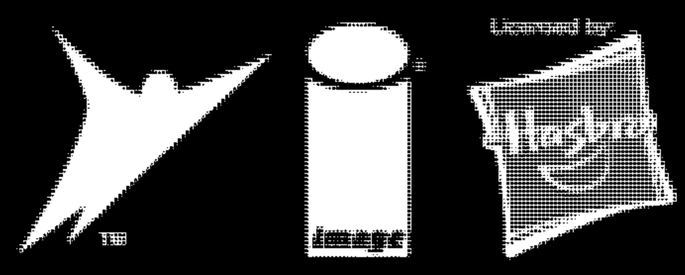
BEN OLIVER

COVER D



JESUS MERINO
& ADRIANO LUCAS

AVAILABLE NOW WHEREVER COMICS ARE SOLD



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TFMEMORY

TRANSFANS